# CLIFFCO

70 Charles Lindbergh Blvd, Suite 200
Uniondale, NY 11553

*Brand guidelines.*

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WHO WE ARE

## We make the mortgage process *clear*.

For more than 37 years, Cliffco has helped families buy, refinance and invest by cutting through the noise that usually surrounds a mortgage. You get straight answers, real numbers, and one loan officer who handles your file from the first click through funding.

**CLEAR**

Plain answers and real numbers, with nothing tucked into the fine print.

**SIMPLE**

Fewer steps and no guesswork about what happens next.

**PERSONAL**

One loan officer who knows your file and answers your call.

**FAST**

An application that takes minutes and a team that keeps every deal moving.

# Our vision

Our vision is to lead as the nation's most innovative and talent-nurturing firm, setting the benchmark for simplicity and collaboration in every partnership.

# Our mission

To transform the dream of homeownership into reality while elevating the net worth and self worth of the families and team members we serve.



# Our values

PERSONALIZATION
**We love to create WOW**

TEAMWORK
**We are stronger together**

INTENTIONALITY
**We are present and aligned in our relationships**

EMPOWERMENT
**We ignite personal responsibility**

INTEGRITY
**We act with unwavering honesty**

ACCOUNTABILITY
**We hold ourselves to a standard of predictable excellence**

ACHIEVEMENT
**We celebrate the wins**

GROWTH
**We cultivate success for our clients and our team**

SECURITY
**We protect everyone we work with**

INNOVATION
**We blaze the trail in a changing world**

# Our voice

## Clear, direct, personal

Cliffco speaks the way the brand looks: clean, confident and uncluttered. We tell people what they need to know in the order they need to know it, and we leave out anything that doesn't help them make a decision. The writing stays warm because there's a real loan officer behind every file, but it never pads a message to sound friendly.

### We lead with the answer

Whether it's a number, a next step or a requirement, the useful part comes first and the context follows after.

### We show the numbers

Specific rates, payments, dates and requirements build more trust than adjectives do, so when we can show the figure, we show it along with the disclosure that goes with it.

### We keep it conversational

Familiar words do most of the work. When an industry term can't be avoided, we explain it in the same sentence so nobody has to look it up.





# Voice in practice

| | INSTEAD OF | WE WRITE |
|---|---|---|
| 01 LEAD WITH THE ANSWER | We're thrilled to offer an amazing variety of competitive mortgage products! | **Here are the three loan options that fit your income and down payment, with the monthly payment for each.** |
| 02 EXPLAIN THE TERM | Your DTI exceeds the guideline threshold for this product. | **Your monthly debts are a little high for this loan compared with your income, so we're looking at two other options that could work.** |
| 03 SHOW THE NUMBER | Rates are at historic lows, so lock in today before it's too late! | **Rates change daily. This example uses a 6.75% rate as of July 21 and is for illustration only.** |
| 04 BE SPECIFIC ABOUT NEXT STEPS | A member of our dedicated team will be in touch shortly. | **Your loan officer will call tomorrow afternoon to go over your documents.** |

# The mortgage process should be black and white.

## Click. Funded.

**Clarity and simplicity that cuts through the noise.**

The brand line leads headline placements such as the website hero, campaign openers and presentation covers. “Click. Funded.” is set in IBM Plex Mono on its own, and in Archivo capitals inside the marketing lockup.





# How we sound

| BE | | DON’T BE | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Clear** | ✓ | Wordy | × |
| **Direct** | ✓ | Vague | × |
| **Specific** | ✓ | Hype-Driven | × |
| **Concise** | ✓ | Jargon-Filled | × |
| **Confident** | ✓ | Pushy | × |
| **Warm** | ✓ | Cold | × |
| **Transparent** | ✓ | Overpromising | × |
| **Conversational** | ✓ | Exclamation-Heavy | × |

# Black, white and one blue

The palette stays in black, white and gray so the one blue has something to stand against. Sky is a light, clear blue that reads as calm and open, and it only works because everything around it is neutral.

**BLACK · PRIMARY**

HEX #0D0D0D
RGB 13, 13, 13
CMYK 74, 67, 66, 85

Headlines, body text, the plate and the secondary pages. Use the rich black build for large printed areas and 100% K for small type.

**WHITE · PRIMARY**

HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255, 255, 255
CMYK 0, 0, 0, 0

Every page background, so the black type and the Sky box carry the message.





# Supporting colors

**SKY · ACCENT**

HEX #BDE8F1
RGB 189, 232, 241
CMYK 22, 0, 5, 0

One word in one box per piece, and the studio forms on pages 29–31. The CMYK is a starting build; match a spot color from a printed swatch book.

**GRAPHITE · PANELS**

HEX #3D4040
RGB 61, 64, 64
CMYK 69, 60, 60, 47

Body text on white, caption panels, cards on black and secondary fields.

**SOFT GRAY · BODY ON BLACK**

HEX #B3B2B4
RGB 179, 178, 180
CMYK 31, 25, 24, 0

Body copy, labels and name lines on black, so headlines stay the brightest thing on the page.

**AIRY GRAY · LIGHT SURFACE**

HEX #F0EEF1
RGB 240, 238, 241
CMYK 5, 4, 2, 0

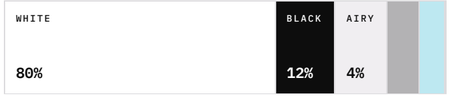
Document panels and alternate light surfaces.

COLOR

# Color in use

White does most of the work and black carries the words. Sky is a sliver, and if a layout looks like it has more blue than that, it does.

APPROXIMATE BALANCE




Photography brings its own color on the website and in print. On social, photos run in black and white until the one color moment described on page 26.

CONTRAST

| PAIR | RATIO | USE |
|---|---|---|
| **Black on White** | 19.4:1 | Headlines, body, the plate |
| **Graphite on White** | 10.5:1 | Body text on white |
| **White on Black** | 19.4:1 | Secondary pages, wordmark |
| **Soft Gray on Black** | 9.2:1 | Body copy on black |
| **Black on Sky** | 14.8:1 | The Sky box; Sky on black in studio |
| **White on Graphite** | 10.5:1 | Caption panels; Sky on Graphite 8.0:1 |

THE SKY BOX

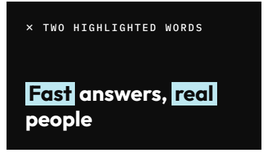
# One word in a Sky box

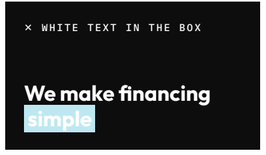
The caption is the brand's signature: bold Outfit, two to six words, with exactly one word set in black on a Sky box. It's what makes a post, a flyer and a video cover read as Cliffco, and Sky is reserved for it.

1. The boxed word is the payoff: the verb, the number or the thing being promised, never "the" or "and."
2. The box is the word's own line box, 1.1 × the type size tall, with 0.15–0.2 em on each side. Square corners, no stroke, no shadow.
3. One box per cover, post, poster or slide. Two highlighted words cancel each other.

× Text inside the box is always black. Sky is never a text color on white, and never on buttons, icons, charts, borders or the logo.



# The logo is the name

Cliffco has no symbol. The logo is the name in Archivo Bold capitals at the SemiExpanded width with wide tracking, held in a solid plate. The plate gives the name the weight of a stamp, and on black the plate drops away so the white letters stand alone.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Typeface** | Archivo 700 Bold, width 112.5% (SemiExpanded) |
| **Tracking** | +200 (0.2 em) at every size |
| **Case** | Always capitals |
| **Plate** | 0.6 em above and below, 1.15 em on each side |
| **Files** | Place the supplied artwork; never retype the logo |




DASHED LINE · CLEAR SPACE OF ONE CAP HEIGHT





# Versions




**Primary.** The black plate on white or Airy Gray, used everywhere it fits.




**On black.** White on black, for dark surfaces and over graded photos.




**Reversed.** Black letters with no plate, only when the surface must stay white and space is tight.

# Lockups

Each lockup keeps the plate unchanged and adds one line of Archivo Medium capitals at about half the wordmark's size, tracked +240. Lockups are logo artwork, so the line is part of the file and is never retyped.




**Mortgage Bankers.** Formal and regulatory materials, letterhead and disclosures.




**Click. Funded.** Marketing, advertising and the website header.



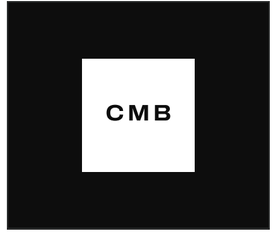

**Financed by.** Partner stamp for agents' and builders' posts and co-branded flyers. Partners place the file; they never retype it.





# The icon

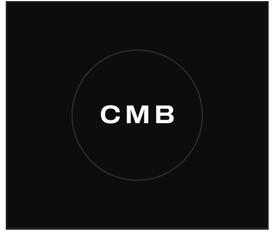
CMB, the initials of Cliffco Mortgage Bankers, in a square plate. It replaces the full logo anywhere it would be under 96 px wide: the favicon, social avatars and app tiles.




ON BLACK




ON WHITE




SOCIAL AVATAR




FAVICON · 16–32 PX

# Size and clear space

Keep one cap height clear on every side of the plate, and measure from the letters when the wordmark stands alone on black. Nothing enters that space, including text, photo edges and other logos.

| MARK | MINIMUM |
|---|---|
| **Wordmark or plate** | 96 px · 0.75 in |
| **Lockups** | 160 px · 1.25 in |
| **Icon** | 32 px · 0.375 in |
| **Favicon** | 16 px |








# Never



TYPOGRAPHY · PRIMARY

# Outfit

Outfit sets everything you read: headlines, captions, body copy and buttons. Set headlines in Bold, in sentence case, with tracking around −1.5% and leading of 1.1 to 1.2. Outfit stops at Bold so it sits comfortably beside Instrument Serif. Set body copy in Regular, or Light at larger sizes, with leading of 1.5 to 1.7.

Outfit is never set in all caps. Archivo appears only inside the logo and lockup artwork, which is placed from the supplied files and never typed.

Aa

**Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 0123456789**

| | |
|---|---|
| Light 300 | Large body text and pull quotes |
| Regular 400 | Body copy |
| Medium 500 | Emphasis in body text and quotes |
| **SemiBold 600** | Buttons and subheads |
| **Bold 700** | Headlines, captions and display |



TYPOGRAPHY · SUPPORTING

# Two faces with narrow jobs

Aa

## IBM Plex Mono

The label and data voice. Eyebrows and labels in Medium capitals tracked +20%; rates, payments and other figures in SemiBold or Bold; name tags, slide numbers, footers and the “Click. Funded.” tagline. It never sets a sentence or a headline.

**$219,600** MAX HOME PRICE

Aa *Aa*

## Instrument Serif

The display accent. Regular in tall Sky capitals for the studio name, and Italic for a guest’s name, a title card, or one word inside a large headline. It never sets body copy, captions or the logo.

Welcome *home.*

# Roles

| ROLE | FACE · WEIGHT | CASE · TRACKING | COLOR | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Wordmark** | Archivo 700 · 112.5% | CAPS · +0.2 em | Black or White | Logo artwork only, never typed |
| **Headline** | Outfit 700 | Sentence case · −0.015 em | Black, White on dark | Page, slide and section titles |
| **Caption** | Outfit 700 | Sentence case · −0.02 em | One Sky box, black text | 2 to 6 words |
| **Body** | Outfit 400 | Sentence case · 0 | Graphite on white, Soft Gray on black | Max 66 characters a line |
| **Button** | Outfit 600–700 | Title case · 0 | Black or White | Square corners |
| **Label · Eyebrow** | IBM Plex Mono 500 | CAPS · +0.2 em | Graphite or Soft Gray | Eyebrows, sublines, footers |
| **Figure · Tag** | IBM Plex Mono 600–700 | As written or CAPS | Black or White | Numbers, name tags, the tagline |
| **Display** | Instrument Serif 400 | CAPS or Italic | Sky on black, or Black/White | Studio name, guest name, one word |

**Screen scale.** Display 96–200 px, caption 72–110 px at 1080 wide, H1 48–64, H2 32–40, body 16–18, labels 11–13.

**Print scale.** H1 30–36 pt, H2 18–22 pt, body 9.5–10.5 pt on 14 pt leading, labels 7–8 pt. Nothing under 9 pt reversed out of black.





# Buttons, fields and cards

Buttons are black and white only. Sky stays in the caption box, so it never competes with the call to action.

BUTTONS

Get Pre-Qualified

Call (800) 834-4040

Apply Now

Contact Us

FORM FIELD

**Gross monthly income ($)**

8,000

Before taxes and deductions

RESULT CARD

MAX HOME PRICE · EXAMPLE

**$219,600**

DOWN PAYMENT
**$40,000**

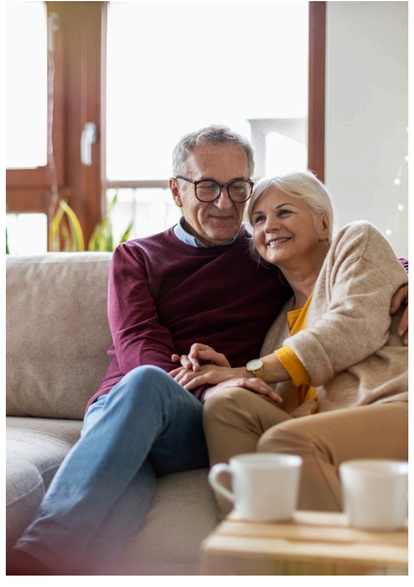
MONTHLY
**$1,845**

Square corners throughout, to match the plate and the Sky box. Borders are 1 px in the line gray, or 1.5 px for secondary buttons.

# Real people, natural light

On the website, in print and in email, photography runs in full color. Choose natural light, real homes and offices, and people in the middle of something genuine, like talking through numbers at a kitchen table or settling into a new home.

Avoid staged handshakes, key handovers and overly corporate stock. Photos have square corners and can run off the edge of the page.





HEADSHOTS

Chest up against a plain light gray backdrop with soft, even light and a natural expression, always in full color.

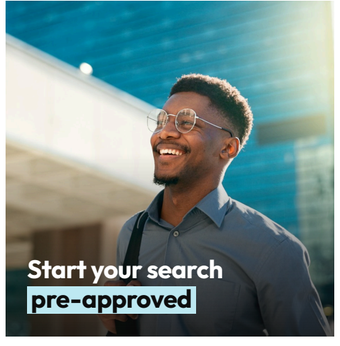




# Photos with the brand




**Team profiles**
The headshot beside a black panel with name, title and NMLS number.




**Caption on photography**
The caption sits lower left over the darkest part of the photo.




**Logo on photography**
The white wordmark top right, over a calm area with a light black gradient where needed.

PHOTOGRAPHY ON SOCIAL

# Black and white, then color

On social, each set of posts walks through a client's journey in black and white photos, from the first search to signing the documents. The final post lands on a single color photo at the moment of success.

Because the rest of the feed stays black and white, that one color photo is the post people stop on, and it gives the whole set a payoff.



JOURNEY · BLACK AND WHITE

Neutral tones, crushed blacks and slightly lifted contrast, with no tints or grain.



SUCCESS · FULL COLOR

No more than one color photo in each set of nine posts.

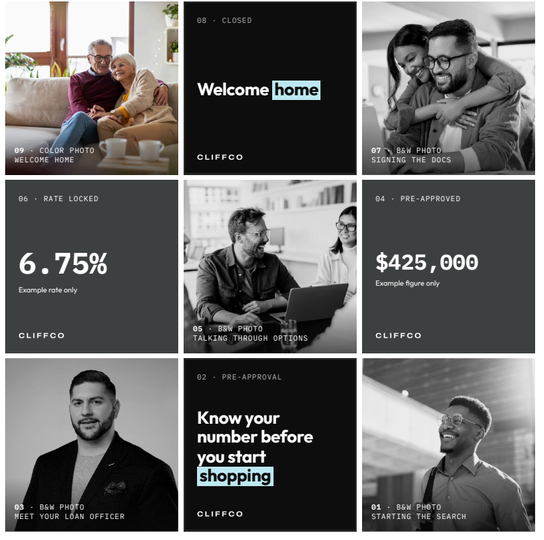


PHOTOGRAPHY ON SOCIAL

# The grid

Photos sit in a checkerboard with black caption tiles and graphite figure tiles, so no two photos sit side by side. Only the caption tiles use the Sky box.

Instagram shows the newest post first, so the color photo is the last post published in each set, which puts it at the top left of the grid. The numbers show posting order, starting from 01 at the bottom right.



SOCIAL

# Covers, thumbnails and posts

Every cover is built the same way: the photo, the caption in its fixed position, and the wordmark top right. On 9:16, keep type 13% off the top and 18% off the bottom, clear of the app's own controls.

| SURFACE | SIZE | CAPTION | POSITION | MARK |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **YouTube thumbnail** | 1280 × 720 | 72–96 px | Lower left, baseline 12% up | Wordmark top right, 180 px wide |
| **Reels · Shorts cover** | 1080 × 1920 | 88–110 px | Lower left, baseline 24% up | Wordmark top right in the safe area |
| **Feed post** | 1080 × 1350 · 1080² | 80–100 px | Lower left, baseline 10% up | Wordmark top right, 150 px wide |
| **Story** | 1080 × 1920 | 88–110 px | Inside the safe area | Wordmark or name tag, not both |
| **Link preview** | 1200 × 627 | 64–80 px | Lower left | Wordmark top right, 170 px wide |
| **Profile avatar** | 1080 × 1080 | None | None | CMB icon, centered |



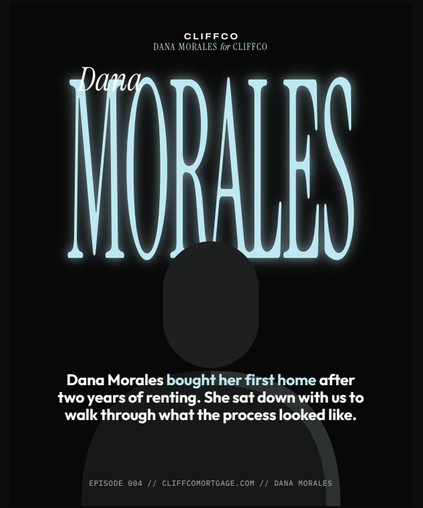
STUDIO AND GALLERY POSTS

# The name on the wall

For interviews, client stories and guest episodes shot on a studio set, Cliffco uses the family's editorial system: a tall Sky serif name behind the subject, numbered quote slides, mono name tags, and B-roll that floats as a glowing screen.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Face** | Instrument Serif Regular, capitals, −0.02 em, Sky |
| **Size** | 80% of the frame width, then stretched vertically only until the caps stand 40% of the frame height |
| **Position** | Cap line 10–12% from the top; the subject stands in front of the lower half |
| **Glow** | Outer glow in Sky, 1.5% of the frame width, 50–55% opacity |
| **Accent** | First name in Instrument Serif Italic, white, over the top left of the big name |
| **Hook** | Outfit Bold at 3.9% of the width, one phrase in Sky; Plex Mono footer at 95% |

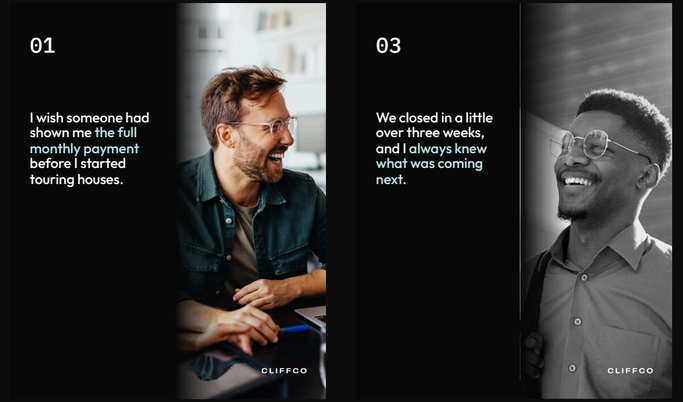
Names and quotes in this section are samples.



# Gallery slides

Every slide after the cover is one thought on one photo, and the number counts the thoughts. The quote is Outfit Medium at 3.9% of the frame width, flush left on a 6.5% margin, no wider than 37% of the frame.

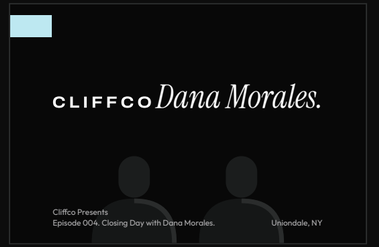
1. The numeral is IBM Plex Mono at 6.7% of the width, top left.
2. One phrase per slide goes Sky; the wordmark sits bottom right.
3. Alternate color and black and white photos so the carousel breathes. The type never changes.





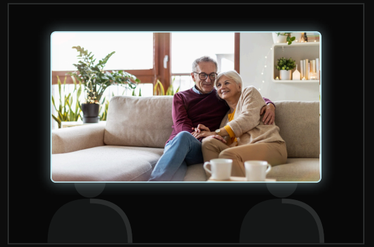



# Title cards, B-roll and name tags



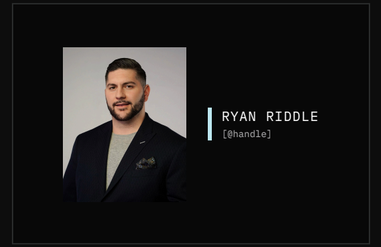

## Title card

A Sky tab at the left edge, the wordmark beside the guest's name in Instrument Serif Italic, and credits in Soft Gray. The tab is the only color on the card.



## B-roll on the floating screen

Nothing cuts away while someone is talking. Footage floats above the table in a 16:9 panel 76% of the frame wide, with a thin Sky edge and soft glow.




## Name tag

IBM Plex Mono capitals with a Sky bar on the left, the handle underneath in Soft Gray. It marks who is speaking or who is in the photo.

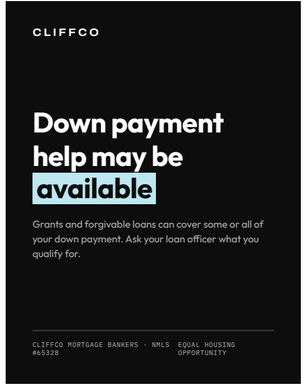
**Where it applies:** interviews, client stories, loan officer features and the carousels cut from them. **Where it doesn't:** everyday posts, rate updates, print and the logo, which never takes the serif, the stretch or the glow.

PRINT

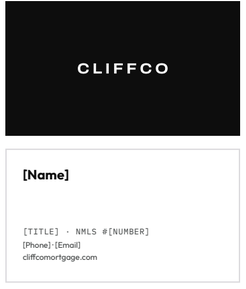
# Black field, white type, one Sky word

Print follows the screen. The field is black, the headline is white, and dense information moves to a white panel in black type.

1. Margins of 6% of the short edge; type flush left and ragged right.
2. Rich black on large fields, 100% K on small type, 0.125 in bleed on every black-field piece.
3. White type at 9 pt or larger when reversed out of black.
4. Sky is C22 M0 Y5 K0 as a starting build, proofed before the run; light tints shift on uncoated stock. No Sky on business cards.
5. Every flyer carries the NMLS number and the Equal Housing Opportunity logo.




FLYER · LETTER




BUSINESS CARD · FRONT AND BACK



QUICK REFERENCE

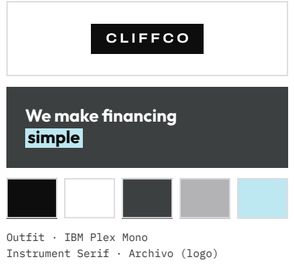
# Before you post or print

## BEFORE YOU POST

- ☐ Caption 2–6 words, Outfit Bold
- ☐ Exactly one word in the Sky box, in black
- ☐ Labels and figures in IBM Plex Mono
- ☐ Wordmark top right, or a name tag, never both
- ☐ Social photos in black and white, one color payoff per set
- ☐ Studio covers: name at 80% width, caps at 40% height, Sky glow

## BEFORE YOU PRINT

- ☐ Outfit, IBM Plex Mono and Instrument Serif installed
- ☐ Logos placed from the supplied files, never typed
- ☐ Rich black fields, 100% K small type
- ☐ Sky proofed from C22 M0 Y5 K0
- ☐ White type 9 pt or larger when reversed; 0.125 in bleed
- ☐ NMLS number and EHO logo on every piece




Outfit · IBM Plex Mono
Instrument Serif · Archivo (logo)

CMB

# Thank *you*.

Click. Funded.